

North Shore Neighborhood Board No. 27
Resolution Regarding Agriculture

WHEREAS, the area now called the North Shore was known in ancient times as *‘āina momona*, or fattened land and it was the breadbasket of O‘ahu; and

WHEREAS, the State Constitution states, “the State shall conserve and protect agricultural lands, promote diversified agriculture, increase agricultural self-sufficiency and assure the availability of agriculturally suitable lands.”¹; and

WHEREAS, many people from Honolulu and around the world are attracted to the beautiful rural setting and lifestyle of the North Shore, thus possibly creating conflicts between some residents and existing farming operations; and

WHEREAS, we support the collaboration and coexistence of all farming businesses in order to keep the country country and promote diversity in the agricultural community; and

WHEREAS, we support all responsible farming practices including best management practices and integrated pest management programs and encourage farmers to be good neighbors; and

WHEREAS, we recognize that the State Department of Agriculture is the appropriate state agency to regulate agricultural activities; and

THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED that prime Ag lands be preserved and used in a sustainable manner for agricultural purposes, local food production, and accessory ag purposes. Renewable energy projects shall be limited to those that make the farm’s or agriculture company’s day-to-day operations more economically viable; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the North Shore Neighborhood Board supports the right of farmers and agricultural businesses to farm their lands within existing laws; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that we encourage the Hawai’i Department of Agriculture and the University of Hawai’i, College of Tropical Agriculture and Human Resources to provide educational opportunities and Cooperative Extension support to farmers in agricultural practices which foster the sustainable growth of our agriculture sector and food security; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the state and county develop appropriate laws, policies and budget allocations to promote vigorous enforcement and prosecution of agricultural trespassing, theft and vandalism to protect farmers and agricultural businesses; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that we urge the State Legislature to fund additional positions within the Department of Agriculture, to help protect and enhance Hawai’i agriculture, including positions for Agriculture Resource Management, plant and animal industries, marketing, invasive species control, food safety education and compliance, and farmer education; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the state Water Commission and Board of Water Supply ensure that adequate water resources are allocated to maintain and increase agricultural production to the fullest extent possible and prevent diversion of North Shore water resources to urban development; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the County complete the wastewater plant improvements at Wahiawa to prevent any more sewage spills, so that Lake Wilson water can be used for growing all food crops on North Shore Ag lands; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Dept. of Education ensure that there are educational programs and experience in the schools to encourage interest in science, agriculture, and agribusiness and that the Department of Labor develop workforce policies for agriculture workers while also addressing agriculture workforce housing; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the State and the County develop policies, resources and opportunities for farmers to obtain land for new and existing farmers, while ensuring land use policies that expedite affordable, long-term leases to farmers and agricultural producers so that they have a stable environment within which to operate and obtain financing; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that agriculture lands will not be CPR'd or otherwise divided without a major permit and public hearing(s); and

BE IT FINALLY RESOLVED that the Secretary is directed to transmit copies of this resolution to the Governor, Senate, House of Representatives, the Chair of the Dept. of Agriculture, the Mayor, the Chair and members of the City Council, the Water Commission, Board of Water Supply, UH College of Tropical Ag and Human Resources, and the Department of Education.

This resolution has been duly discussed, considered, and voted upon in the affirmative by the North Shore Neighborhood Board on 2/25/2020.

Signed Kathleen M. Pahinui
Kathleen Pahinui, Chair

Date: 3/1/2020

¹ Article XI, Section 3 of the State Constitution.

Revised and Approved by the NSNB Ag Committee 2-24-2020

Approved by the full NSNB Board 2-25-2020